

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Identity and Access Management | Microsoft 365 Security | Azure | Zero Trust | Detection Engineering

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience leading security engineering projects across identity, device, and cloud platforms. I have deep expertise in Microsoft 365 security, Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), and Conditional Access - the technology stack that underpins a Zero Trust security model. I am experienced in owning security engineering projects end-to-end, from design and planning through to implementation, documentation, and transition into business-as-usual (BAU) operations. I bring strong capability in detection engineering, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) tuning, and supporting Security Operations Centre (SOC) analysts to identify and respond to identity-related security incidents. I am a collaborative, proactive engineer who operates effectively in fast-moving environments and is passionate about reducing the attack surface through robust identity controls, cloud security hardening, and measurable improvements to an organisation's security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access Policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), Group Policy
- **Microsoft 365 (M365) Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365 Defender), Microsoft Purview, Information Protection
- **Microsoft Azure Security:** Azure Security Centre, Entra Identity, Conditional Access, Azure Policy; cloud security controls design and implementation
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL) - detection rule authoring, analytics, alert tuning); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, PowerShell automation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune; endpoint security baseline enforcement
- **Zero Trust Architecture:** Zero Trust principles applied across identity, device, network, and application layers
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; penetration test support and remediation
- **Incident Response:** Identity-related incident investigation, root-cause analysis, NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Act as the specialist in identity, access, and cloud security controls, supporting the secure operation of the organisation's Microsoft 365 and Azure environments across an 8,000-user estate.
- Own security engineering projects end-to-end across the identity and cloud security domain, from design and planning through to implementation, documentation, and transition into business-as-usual (BAU) operations.

- Improve overall security posture in line with Zero Trust principles, rolling out new Microsoft 365 cloud security features and Conditional Access controls to enforce least-privilege access and reduce the attack surface.
- Enhance identity and access logs and signals within detection and response tooling, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules and analytics in Microsoft Sentinel to improve visibility of identity-related threats.
- Tune identity-related alerts in Microsoft Sentinel in partnership with Security Operations Centre (SOC) analysts, reducing false positives and improving signal-to-noise ratio.
- Support investigations into identity-related security incidents and lead root-cause analysis, drawing on CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Identity telemetry.
- Manage Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access Policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and Privileged Identity Management (PIM).
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege and just-in-time access for privileged accounts and service identities.
- Configure and manage Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) security baselines and compliance policies.
- Deploy and maintain Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), managing policy configuration, alert investigation, and threat hunting.
- Contribute to internal audits, penetration test exercises, and regulatory reviews relating to identity, access, and cloud security domains.
- Develop PowerShell scripts and Microsoft Sentinel Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate common response actions and reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Managed identity and access governance including user provisioning, access reviews, and role-based access control (RBAC) across Microsoft Active Directory and Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory).
- Performed Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alert triage and investigation, correlating identity, endpoint, and network events to identify and contain threats.
- Supported SOAR playbook development to automate common identity-related response actions such as account lockdown, credential reset, and session revocation.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments, tracked remediation activity, and assisted with penetration test exercises across identity and cloud environments.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns to strengthen the human layer of the organisation's security posture.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ certification activities, documenting identity and access management controls for audit submission.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support in a SaaS and FinTech environment, implementing identity, endpoint, and network security controls.
- Configured MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and Active Directory Group Policy to enforce a Zero Trust-aligned, least-privilege access model.
- Managed MDM/MAM policies for corporate devices, ensuring endpoint security compliance across the device fleet.
- Performed regular vulnerability scans, coordinated remediation with development and operations teams, and contributed to ISO 27001-aligned security management activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, providing unified identity and endpoint protection under the Microsoft Defender platform.

- Designed and implemented Conditional Access Policies in Microsoft Entra Identity that enforce Zero Trust access principles, significantly reducing the risk of identity-based compromise.
- Built detection engineering capability in Microsoft Sentinel through the development of Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics and automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, improving mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the organisation's privileged account estate, enforcing just-in-time access and reducing standing privilege exposure.
- Led end-to-end CrowdStrike Falcon deployment, establishing comprehensive endpoint detection and response (EDR) capability across the enterprise.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating strong foundational security controls across identity, endpoint, and network layers.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)